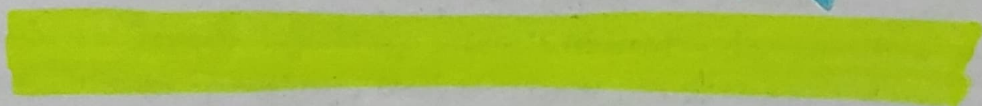


# ANCIENT MEDIEVAL HISTORY



# PRE HISTORY

**MARKER POINT** : Homo Erectus → Coarctation Capacity (1400-1950 cc), started using tools  
Arun Sonakia → Skull in Narmada River, Rajendran → Baby skull in Odai (TN)

**Time** : BC Before Christ → BCE Before Common Era, AD Anno Domini → CE Common Era

|                                            |            |                                  |                       |
|--------------------------------------------|------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Paleolithic</b> : 2 million - 10000 BCE | : Stone    | : Hunter / Gatherer, Caves, fire | : Bhimbetka, Hunsgi   |
| <b>Mesolithic</b> : 10000 BCE - 4000       | : tools    | : Domestication, semi nomadic    | : Bagor, Mahadaha     |
| <b>Neolithic</b> : 4000 BCE - 1000         | : Polished | : agriculture, domestication     | : Mehrgarh, Burzahom  |
| <b>Chalcolithic</b> : 3000 BCE - 700       | : Copper   | : Rural settlement, farming      | : Anur, Tolwe, Malwa  |
| <b>Iron Age</b> : 1000 BCE onward          | : Iron     | : Clear forest, urban, ironpad   | : Atranjikhara, Mallu |

**PALEOLITHIC** : 2.5 million - 10000 : Stone Age during Ice age (Pleistocene epoch -30°C)

**Early / Lower** : 2.5m - 1m : Handaxe, cleaver, chopper : Large chipped stone tool

**Middle** : 1m - 40000 : Flakes, blades, points, borer : Smaller tool

**Late / Upper** : 40000 - 10000 : chips, parallel blade, burin : may have used wood / bones

**Feature** → Hunter, Gatherer, close to water, Open air or Caves, use fire, crude tools, limited people  
**Sites** : Soan Valley, Narmada, Belan, Kurnool, Bhimbetka (Cave painting)

**MESOLITHIC** : 10000 - 4000 : Holocene Epoch (15°C) → Animals loose excess fat and hair  
**Evolution** → animal faster → existing tool useless → smaller micro sharper tools

**Features** : Warm → Greenery → Gathering, small animal → domestication, Nomadic, Burial

**Sites** : Bagor, Tilwara, Langhnaj, Chopani Mandi, Sarai Nahar, Adamgarh, Chota nagpur

**NEOLITHIC** : 7000 - 1000 : 6000 years to learn agriculture → agrarian → social stratification

**Domestication of plants** → Surplus → Need of controlling → Complex Society → Early state

**Tools** : agriculture based tools, grinding tools, agriculture → Storage → Pottery

**Features** : Sedentary life, Neolithic revolution → surplus, Early states, (Wheat + millet + Ragi + Bori)

**Sites** : Mehrgarh, Koldihwa, Mahagara, Burzahom, Chirand, Maski, Brahmagiri,

Texkalakota, Sang an Kallu, Nagarjunakonda, Pallavoy, Uthur, Sendoorimalai

Burzahom → pit dwelling (cold env), South Ach mound → Collection of Burnt ashes.

**CHALCOLITHIC** : 3200 - 1600 → Smelting (melting ore) → Copper → tools (Pottery + Urbanization)

**Feature** : Copper use, Bone tools, Rice based culture, Social stratification

Banas (2600-1900) Har culture, Kayatha (2400-2000) in Chambal, Torwe (1400-700) Maharashtra

Malwa (1700-1400) diff crops in MP, Indus valley → No commonality in any

**INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION** : 3200 - 1300 BCE : First Urbanisation

**Discovery** : 1926 by Charles Masson in Harappa → Archaeological survey Ind (Alexander Cunningham) 1871

**Extent** : N Shortugai, W Sutkagendor, E Alamgirpur, S Daimabad, Copper work → X Orange trees

**Feature** : Citadel and Lower town, town planning, mounds, grid, water / sewage,

Uniform bricks, Designed houses, Great bath, Granaries, Assembly hall

**Economy** : Copper + crafts + (Lead zinc tin) + stones + carts + traders, (Wheat + Barley + Rice + Millet)

**Crafts** : black on red pottery, Seals, ornaments, terracotta

**Trades** : Cross items internal, seals, Mesopotamian text → Meluha Description, Oman trade

**Society** : Stratified, labour division, Patriarchy,

**writing** : 3700 object, 450 signs Religion : Naturalistic (pure form), Phashupati, Mother goddess

**Polity** : Mature political body, (Merchant rule / priest king rule)

**Decline** : 1900 1700 trade decline, Dark patch - flooding, Light patch - draught

# VEDIC PERIOD

TRANSITION : 1700-1500 BCE → Dark Age (No archaeological evidence, literary records)  
Aryan migration during this → These people diff from Ind

LANGUAGE : INWARD Mig → Sanskrit daughter of European (Bring by Aryan)  
THEORY OUTWARD Mig → Sanskrit mother of all (Aryan migrated outside)

ARYAN : Linguistic Ethnic group, Nomadic Pastoralist, Author of Veda

## EARLY VEDIC : 1500-1000 BCE

Economy : Primary Pastoralism (cattle), diverse (Agri + Artisan + Dasa Dasi)  
Period of regression (no currency, no land, no trade), Barter system  
Political : Rajan (Protector of people + cattle), Elected, No tax, Bali (Gift) to Rajan  
Vidhatha (Assembly - Cultural), Sabha (Elders), Samiti (adults under Rajan)  
Administration : Jana Rajan (Chief) → Vis Vishpati → Grama → Kula (home)  
Purohit (Priest), Senapati (Command), Vrajapati (pasture), Purupati (forts)  
Society : Occupation → Power differentiation, Not fully patriarchal, patrilineal  
Varna → Brahmin (Priest), Kshatriya (fight), Egalitarian (everyone equal)  
Religion : Naturalistic, Indra (rain) → main, Agni, Soma, Surya etc. represent nature  
Feature : Chieftain tribal, wealth → cattle → war → Dasa, Women freedom

## LATER VEDIC : 1000-500 BCE

Economy : Primary agri, wealth → Land, Iron used, Rise in blacksmith, Artisans +  
Exchange with barter, Oxen drawn wagon, Chariots, Kshetra (fertile land)  
Polity : Rajan (Monarchical protector), territorial state, leader in battle, chosen by god  
Priest → yajna (Ashwamegha, Rajasuya, Vajapeya)  
Bhaga → Land revenue (1/3 or 1/6 as Bali) → compulsory taxation → Sangrahitri  
Sabha : Nominated by King  
Administration : Bhagadugha - collector, Kshata - Royal household, Stapati - governor  
Vacabhumika - police, Akshavapa - accountant, Mahishi - chief queen  
Society : Varna → Brahmin / Kshatriya / Vaishya (agri/commerce) / Shudra (maintenance)  
Rigid category, Born into, Shudra discriminated, Women → Lower status  
Religion : Vedic Brahmanism, Prajapati + Rudra + Vishnu, Ritual + Sacrifices  
Features : Monarchy territorial divine kingship, Varna, Land wealth, Taxation,  
highly stratified, Patriarchal.

## Vedic Literature : Shuti (heard), Smriti (remembered)

- 1) Rig Veda → Hymns to god → Oldest texts (1500-1000 BCE)
- 2) Sama Veda → Music / chanting → Used in rituals, basis of classical music
- 3) Yajur Veda → Ritual / sacrifice → Prose and verse mixed
- 4) Atharva Veda → Magic healing rituals → Daily life, charms, spells, reflect beliefs

Brahmana : Explain Veda → Attharva Kaushitaki, Tondya Jaiminiya, Shatopatha Taittiriya, Gopatha

Aranyakas : Forest books → Philosophical meditation

Upanishad : Vedanta → Spiritual knowledge, philosophy, Brahma Atma Moksha Karma

Early Vedic : Sapta Sindhu, Kunikhetra, Gondera, Indus, Sutlej, Gomutra Doab

Later Vedic : UP Doab, Kosala, Videha, Kuru, Panchal, Magadha.

# MAHAJANPADA

**JANPADAS** : 1000 BCE - 600 BCE (Land of tribe)

early vedic (semi nomadic) → later vedic (settling permanently)

tribal ruled by Rajon, Sabha + Samiti, 22 Janpads (Early Monarchical system)

**TRANSITION** : Iron → cleared forest in Ganga, Agriculture expansion, Urbanisation, Political centralization → Strong Monarchy, Philosophical change

**MAHAJANPADAS** : 600 - 300 BCE (16 great land of peoples)

Monarchies (1 man rule) : Gandhara, Kamboji, Kashi, Vatsa, Avanti, Chedi, Kuru, Panchal, Matsya  
Republics (gansanghas) : Assaka, Malla, Vajji

Magadha, Surasena, Kosala, Anga

**Economic** : Emergence of punch coin, private land, population growth in Ganga → village size ↑  
Urban centres (cities), Nagara (fort/town), Rajadhami (capital city)  
Rajdhami → Mahanagar → Pura → Nagar / Nagavika / Nigum

**Magadha rise** : All mahajanpad fought → Magadha (Bimbisara + Ajatashatru) emerge victorious  
Reason : Strategic location + Iron deposit + plateau + river (son, Ganga, Champa)  
Dynasties → Haryanka (544-413) → Shishunaga (413-345) → Nanda

**Trade route** : Utharpatna → major transregional route in north India (Gangatic plain)  
Dakshinpatna → Patliputra - Pratisthana (Godavari) - Western ports

## MAGADHA EMPIRE

1) **HARYANKA DYNASTY** 544 - 413 BCE

Bimbisara : 544-492 : Founder, Buddha contemporary, annexed anga, matrimonial (Kosala Vaishali)

Ajatashatru : 492-460 : Killed father, Mahashil Kantaka, annexed Vajji, 1st Buddhist Council

Udayin : 460-444 : Founded Patliputra (capital) → centralization

Amurudha → Munda → Nagadasaka (444-413) → weak successor → replaced by Shishunaga

2) **SHISHUNAGA DYNASTY** 413 - 345 BCE

Shishunaga : 413-395 : minister → king, annexed Avanti, Vaishali capital

Kalashoka : 395-367 : 2nd Buddhist Council, divide empire among sons → weaken

Nandivardhana → Mahanandid (367-345) → internal division → replaced by Nanda

3) **NANDA DYNASTY** 345 - 322 BCE

Mahapadma Nanda : 345-340 : Ekarat, Destroyer of Khatiya, Shudra, Built massive army

Dhana Nanda : 329-322 : Last ruler, oppressive taxation → discontent

Defeated by Chandragupta Maurya → Mauryan Dynasty.

# BUDDHISM, JAINISM, AJIVIKISM

## BUDDHISM:

Most popular religion during 500 BCE - 300 CE, Easy to follow, adopted by political  
Siddhartha (Lumbini-Birth) → Renunciation (Mahabhisiksha Kramana - 29 - Left home) →  
Enlightenment (Nirvana - Bodhgaya - 35) → First Sermon (Dharmachakra Pravartan  
to 5 ascetics → Mahaparinirvana (Death - 80 - Kushinagar)  
Three jewels → Buddha (enlightened) + Dhamma (teaching) + Sangha (monastic order)  
Ariya sacchchani : Ashtamarga (8 fold path) + Dukha (Suffering) +  
(4 noble truths) Cause (It has cause) + Nirodha (It can be removed)  
8 fold path : Right view + intention + speech + action + livelihood + effort + mind + samadhi  
Buddhist council : total 4  
1st : 483 : Ajatashatru → wrote text : Vinay (Rule of monk) + Sutta (Saying of Buddha)  
2nd : 383 : Kalasoka → Split : Mahasanghika (Unorthodox dilute) + Theravada (Vinay Pitaka)  
3rd : 250 : Ashoka → 3rd Pitaka Abhidhamma (interpretation of Sutta + Philosophy)  
4th : 72 AD : Kanishka → Split : Mahayana (god + idol) + Hinayana (Buddha teacher)  
School of Buddhism :  
Theravada : Oldest + Vinay Pitaka + Arhat (Buddha hood) + Developed in Sri Lanka  
Mahayana : Idol worship of god + flexible + Bodhisattvas (group of demigod)  
Hinayana : Buddha is teacher + worship of symbol + Orthodox (discipline + strict meditation)  
Vajrayana : Shortcut (mantra + tantra) + Main deity (Tara)

## JAINISM:

Extremely rigid, Non attractive, uncompromising, difficult to follow, by Rishabh Nath  
Jina (Enlightened one ∞ knowledge) → Jaina (follower, want to attain moksha (liberation))  
Thirthankara : ford builder, bridge across ocean of suffering  
22 : Neminatha (Guj) → 23 : Parshvanath (Benaras) → 24 : Mahavir (Vardhamana)  
Vardhamana (Kundagrama - Birth) → Renunciation (30) → Aseptic (wandering - 12 years) →  
Kevalajhana (Enlighten 13th y - sal tree) → Jna (30 years) → Mahaparinirvana (527 - 72 age)  
Tirthna : Samyag darshana (faith) + Samyag darshana (knowledge) + Samyag charitra (conduct)  
Panch Mahavrat : ahimsa + satya + brahmacharya + asteya (no steal) + aparigraha (non possession)  
Jainism Schools :  
Digamber : south (Bhadra bahu) → Nudity + strict + carry sajoharana (broom) and Ramandala  
Svetamber : north (Stul bahu) → wear white + fluid + worship idol or teacher  
Jain council :  
1st : 300 BC (Stul bahu) → Patliputra → Preservation of knowledge orally  
2nd : 512 CE (Devachigiri) → Vallabhi → Svetambars created 12 angas + 12 upangas in book form

## AJIVIKISM:

Niyati (fate / pre destination) → human suffers no consequences + Karma +  
Father (Mankhali Gosala 600 BCE) in magadha (Bihar), Mother (Bhadra)  
Important site → Barabar Hills (Ajivika caves - Bihar)

# MAURYAN DYNASTY

## MAURYAN DYNASTY 321-185 BCE

- Rulers :** Chandragupta (324-297) → Bindusara (298-272) → Ashoka (268-232)
- Politics :** Kautilya Arthashastra → Concentration of Power to king → official → people
- 7 limbs :** Swami, Amatya (official), Kosha, Durga, Janpad, Mitra, Danda (law)
- Admin :** Central : Swami → Tirthas (HOD) → Adhyakshas (high off.) → Mahamattas → Amatya  
Provisional : Kumara / Aryaputra → Pradesika (district) + Rajuka (rural) + Yukta (secretary)  
Sthanika (collector) + Gopa (accountant) + Gramika (village)
- Terms :** Mantri, Purohit, Senapati, Yuvaraja, Duvvika, Nayaka (city constable), Vyavaharika (chief justice), Dandapal (police), Antapal (defence)
- Economy :** Primary agri, + Hunting Gathering + Pastoralism, State control Economy  
Taxes : Bhaga (land), Vastani (road), Nishkramya (Export), Vishti (labour)  
Trade : blooming, Jataka story, Security → trade ↑, West Asia and Central Asia
- Societies :** Megasthenes : seven state → philosophy + farmer + herd + trade + soldier + overseer + council  
Arthashastra : wage labour, bonded labour, slave labour  
Brahmanical (untouchability), Women low, Shudras impure

- Chandragupta Maurya 324-297 :** Consolidate without fighting, Sandracottus in greek matrimonial alliance with Seleucus, Junagadh Inscription, Sudarshan lake
- Bindusara : 297-272 :** Expanded territory, in Sangam lit, patronised ajivika sect  
Amittokhates / Amittaghattha, good diplomatic relation by Deimachus
- Ashoka : 273-232 :** the great, Kalinga bloodshed, converted buddhism → Spread dhamma  
Issued edicts (rock + pillars), Killed brothers to gain power
- Later Mauryan :** weak rulers → last Brihadratha → Killed by Pushyamitra Shunga
- Decline of mauryan :** Admin distress + Economic decline + religious conflict + extend pram.

- ALEXANDER :** Ruler of Macedon, Ruled 327 BC Greece + Persia + Egypt + Gaza + Syria  
march toward India → Ambhi (Taxila) → ruled lordship  
Porus (Jhelum) → fought bravely → lost → friendship with alexander
- Seleucus Nicator (governor) :** rebelled and expanded → moved toward Indus  
Daughter of Seleucus married Chandragupta → Matrimonial alliance
- Sources :** Indica (Megasthenes), Fahien / Tsang (Chinese), Ceylon (Buddhist)

- ASHOKA DHAMMA :** Politico Religious philosophy → to consolidate his empire
- Principles :** Ahimsa + good conduct + concord + mutual respect + social responsibilities
- Sources :** Buddhist texts + 84000 Stupas + Inscription (rock and pillar edicts)
- Major Rock Edicts :** 14 Edicts + 2 Kalinga → Kabi, Girnar, Sopara, Dhuli, Jaugada
- Minor Rock Edicts :** Personal + moral instruction → Bahmagiri, Maski, Palkigundu
- Pillar Edicts :** 1 major pillar + minor ones → Nandangarh, Sanchi, Samath, Delhi
- Cave Inscription :** Barabar caves (Ajivika sect) → Bihar
- Language :** Prakrit (Brahmi), Greek, Aramaic (Kharosthi)

# SANGAM

## MEGALITHIC PERIOD : 1500 - 300 BCE

- Feature : Agriculture + Pastoral, Use of copper/iron (according to deposit)  
Social stratification, Mature state, No literature, Unciphered writings
- Megaliths : Big stone burial structure (monuments to show power → Stratification)  
Chambered (Gir / Dolmen / Dolman), Unchambered (Pit / Urn / Sarcophagus)  
TN (Adichanallur, Puzhampalli), K (Brahmagiri, Hallur), AP (Nagarjunkonda, Telleswaram)

## SANGAM AGE : 300 BCE - 300 CE

- Feature : Sangam text, Stability in south region, Tamilakam regions
- Economy : Primary (Agriculture), Trade (Internal + maritime trade with Rome, SE Asia)
- Admin : Nanna / Vandan / Korraivan (King) as centre with Amaichhar (Minister)  
Purohitar, Dutar (Envoy), Senapatiyan, Orar (Spies), Vaniyar (collector)  
Mandalam → Nadu (District) → Ur (Town) → Perur + Sivur (Village)  
Revenue : Karai (Land), Irarai (war tribute), Ulgu (Custom), Iravu (forced gift)
- Society : non-rigid varna : Brahmanas, Arshavar (King), Vaishyas, Velalar (farmer)  
Kuli : Clan based, Hereditary occupation  
Natukal → memorial stones for warrior died, Vattaiyal → lost king starvation

- CHOLA** : Tigai : Uraiyur : textile : Karikala → founded Puhar, constructed Corvay Dam
- CHERA** : Bow : Vanji : spices : Senguttuvan → founded Pallavi cult worship Kannagi
- PANDYA** : Fish : Madurai : pearls : Nedunjelian → performed Ashwamedha

## IMPORTANT LITERATURE →

- Early work : Tolkappiyam → oldest Tamil grammar and poetic text
- Ettutotai : 8 Anthology → Akam (love poem) + puram (war/royal)
- Pattu pattu : 10 short poem or idylls, Tirai → attach emotion to environment
- Padinenki Kanakku : 18 minor works, often panegyrics
- Epics : 5 great poem → Jivaka Chintamani, Sillappadikaram, Manimekalai, Valayapathi, Kundalakesi

# POST MAURYAN DYNASTIES

## POST MAURYAN PERIOD : 185 BCE - 300 CE

- Fragmentation of Mauryan Dynasty + Foreign invasion → rise of regional dynasties
- Polity : Monarchical rule, Period of tolerance, patronage to all religion  
Shunga 184 → Indogreek 168 → Saka 150 → Satvahanas 100 → Kushana 30 CE
- Trade : Highest point of overseas trade, connect with Greece + Roman + Egypt + China etc  
Ptolemy's Geography (200 AD) → China (Silk + Porcelain)  
Pliny's History → Roman bleeding gold to India in exchange of spices
- Society : Jati formation → Sub categorization of Varna (foreigner assimilation + inter marriage)  
Land grants to Brahmin and in lieu of services
- Economy : trade, use of coins, taxation, Urbanization
- Decline : Low income, foreign decline, excessive land grants, Decentralization, Gupta ↑

## SUNGAS 184-75 BCE

- Rulers : Pushyamitra → Agnimitra → Vasumitra → Bhagabhadra → Devabhuti  
Harshacharita text : Pushyamitra (commander) → Killed Brihadratha (Maurya)
- Features : Emergence of various mixed caste, integration of foreign in society, Sanskrit + Pali  
text : Patanjali (Mahabhasya), (Ashtadhyayi) Panini

## INDO GREEK (INDO BACTRIAN KINGDOM) 180 BCE - 10 CE

- Rulers : Demetrius → Apollodotus → Menander → Zoilos → Heliodes → Hermaeus → Strato II  
After Alexander death → Demetrius invaded India → Menander most powerful ruler
- Features : Nagasena book Milindapanha → Menander converted into buddhism  
Introduced double die struck coin → Kings + gods → Kharosthi + Brahmi script  
Issued first gold coins but did not circulated

## SAKAS 78-130 CE (SCYTHIANS DYNASTY)

- Ruler : Moza earliest ruler from tarala, displaced to India b/c of Chinese Yueh chi tribe  
Two faction : Ujjain Kardamaka → Chastana → Rudrasaman  
Mundore Kshatrapas → Nahapana (Ruled over Gandhara region)
- Features : Decentralised governance via Satrapas, Revival of Sanskrit, Maritime trade expansion  
Junagadh inscription : earliest Sanskrit, Art = Hellenistic + Persian + Indian

## SATVAHANAS 100 BCE - 224 CE (Brahmin Rulers)

- Rulers : Simuka → Satakami → Hala → Gautamiputra Satkarni → Pulumavi → Yagnasri  
Simuka (founder after Ashoka death), Gautamiputra defeated Shaka ruler
- Features : Matrilineal Dynasty, Centralized administration, Ahara - province  
Different shaped coin found at many places, Chaitya + Chakra + Conch + Lotus + Ship

## KUSHANA 30 CE - 375 CE

- Rulers : Kujula → Taktu → Vima → Kanishka → Huvishka → Vasudeva → Vasishka  
Kujula united Yue-chi / Tachiran tribe
- Features : Kanishka issued gold coins, greek + hindu deities,  
Samath inscription : Kanishka divided empire into several provinces  
Patronized Mahayana Buddhism (specially Kanishka)

# GUPTA DYNASTY

## GUPTA DYNASTY 320 - 550 CE (Golden age for Art and Culture)

- Ruler :** Chandragupta I (319-335) → Samudragupta (335-375) → Chandragupta II (375-415) → Kumaragupta (415-455) → Skandagupta (455-467) → Vishnugupta
- Sources :** Kamandaka (Nitisara), Vajjika (Kaumudi), Sudraka (Murchchakatika), Visakhadatta (Chandraguptam), Somadeva (Kathasaritsagara)
- Literary :** Kalidasa (Abhijnana, Malavikagnimitram, Vikramorwastham, Kumarasambhava, Meghadoota, Ritusamhara, Raghuvamsha), Vishnu Sharma (Panchatantra), Aryabhatta (Surya Siddhanta, Aryabhatiyam), Susrutha (Samhita)
- Admin :** Empire → Uparikas (Bhuktas) → Vishayas → Grama → Gihis (Nigamasabhas)  
Seals and inscription mention ranks, Kumaramatya → high ranking officials
- Economy :** Agriculture (land → Kshetra), Crafts and luxury items, silk + cotton  
Bhoga (North land revenue), Bhoga (supplies of items), Kara (taxes - Bali)
- Society :** Brahmana supremacy → Land grants, conquerors given status of Kshatriya  
Agrarian expansion → tribal assimilation + Shudra + women entry.
- Religion :** Vedas to Puranas (Vishnu Purana, Shakti as goddess, Dasavatara concept), assimilation of gods

## GUPTA RULERS

- Srigupta :** Founder, title as Maharaja, built buddhist vihara at Mougasikhavana
- Chandragupta I :** matrimonial alliance with Lichchavi, started Gupta era, inscription of Gupta era
- Samudragupta :** delighted in violence and conquest, divided empire into 5 groups
- Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya) :** Conquest + alliances, Chinese Fa Hien visited, silver coins
- Kumaragupta :** Introduced worship of God Kartikeya in North India, founded Nalanda University
- Vishnugupta :** Last Ruler, Feudatories + decline of foreign trade → decline of Gupta

## VAKATAKAS 250 - 500 CE

- Satvahanas → Vakatakas (local power), Mentioned as Vindhyaakas in Puranas
- Rulers :** Vindhyaashakti (250 CE) → Pravarasena (270) → Rudrasena (330) → Harisena (475)
- Branches :** Nandivardhana : Nagpur : Pravarasena + Rudrasena → Political alliance with Gupta  
Vatsagulma : Akola : Harisena → Patron of Ajanta Cave
- Features :** Brahmins who promoted Brahmanism, large scale of copperplate land grants

# POST GUPTA ERA

## POST GUPTA 250 - 800 CE

- Features : Decentralized politics, Feudalizing Mentality, Fragmented army/administration  
Decline of trade, Deurbanisation
- Source : Bonalhatta (Harshacharita), Hsien Tsang (Si-Yu-ki), Inscription Banakhera, Madhuban  
Harshvardhan (Ratnavali, Nagananda, Priyadarika) - Haridatta + Jayasena
- Tripartite Struggle : 750-900 CE, between Palas, Pratiharas and Rashtrakutas  
Control of Kannauj and Gangesic plains
- Small Dynasties : Western ganga of Mysore (Talukad 250-1000 CE), Banvazi (Konkan 345-524 CE)  
Yashodharmann (Malwa), Later Gupta (Gupta of Malwa - Gaya), Maukharis (Bengal)  
Nabhakas of Vallabhi (475 CE - Gujarat), Gaudas of Bengal (Murshidabad 600-672 CE)

## PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

- 500 - 647 CE (Vardhan Dynasty)
- Rulers : Pushyabhuti → Prabhakarvardhana (2 sons) → Rejyavardhana II (605) → Harshavardhana (607)  
Thanesar (modern Haryana) → Kannauj (UP) during Harshavardhana
- Polity : Huang shang mentioned Law and order was problematic, Conflict with Huns in North
- Admin : Fragmented army, Land grants in lieu of Salary, Finances not good, decentralized  
Revenue = King Expenditure + Scholars + Officials + Religion

## CHALUKYAS

- Early (540 - 800 CE) - Later (1000 - 1200 CE)
- Features : ruled South and central region, present day Karnataka + Maharashtra + Konkan
- Badami : 543 - 753 (Early Chalukyas), Pulakesin founded and ruled from Vatapi  
Pulakesin → Kirtivarman → Mangalesha → Pulakesin II → Vikramaditya  
Rock cut cave at Badami, Vesara style - Cradle of Indian temple Architecture
- Vengi : 624 - 1070 CE (Eastern Chalukyas), Founded by Vishnuvardhana (brother of Pulakesin II)  
Vishnuvardhana → Vijaya ditya II, III → Bhima → Vijayaditya IV (Capital - Vengi)  
Marital relation with Chola, military expedition against Rashtrakutas.
- Kalyani : 973 - 1189 CE (Western Chalukyas), Founded by Tailapa II after Rashtrakutas decline  
Tailapa → Satyashraya → Vikramaditya VI (Chalukya Vikrama Era) → Someshwara
- Lata : 970 - 1074, founded by Nimbarka near Gujarat → Baroppe (prominent ruler)

## PALLAVAS

(275 - 897 CE)

- Rulers : Simhavishnu → Mahendra varman → Narasimhavarmann → Mahendravarman II →  
Narasimhavarmann II → Nandi varman II → Aparajita Pallava
- Feature : Capital - Kanchipuram, Art and Culture Superiority, Kept South stable  
Vijayaka Feudatory → created Chola Dynasty, Arghat (Persian wheel)
- Mahendra style : Mahendravarman I → Rock cut cave, simple pillars, lion base
- Rajasimha style : Narasimhavarmann I → structural temples, ornate gopurams, vimanas

## TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE

- Earlier Pataliputra was centre of power, (Uttarpath and Dakshinpath merge in this area)
- After medieval → Power shifted to Kannauj (fertile alluvial land)
- Three power existed : Gujara Pratihara / Palas / Rashtrakutas  
(Harshvardhan) (Varmans) (Chalukyas)

# EARLY MEDIEVAL

## PALAS DYNASTY 750-1200 CE

Features : Known for Buddhism / Paintings, South East Asian sector relation, Language Abahatta  
Rulers : Gopala (750) → Dharmapala (770) → Devapala (810) → Mahipala → Ramopala → Madanapala  
(Patronized Nalanda, Vikramashila University Bhagalpur) (end → Sena took over)

## GURJARA PRATI HARAS 730-1018 CE

Features : Originated from Gujara (Tribe) → pastoralist + fighter, Tripartite Power, Khajuraho temple  
Ruler : Nagabhatta I (725) → Bhoja (836) → Mahendrapala (890) → Mahipala (912) → Rajyopal (960)  
(main founder, recovered Kannauj, HHe Adivarsa) (Extended over Magadha, Bengal)

## RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY 755-975 CE

Features : Dantidurga formed capital (Manyakhett) Sholapur, Vaishnavites, dominated north Maharashtra  
Rulers : Dantidurga (735) → Govinda (793) → Amoghvarsh (814) → Indra III → Krishna (939) → Karka (972)  
tolerant to religion (even Islam), faced many rebellion, reestablished the empire, last brilliant

## CHOLA DYNASTY 850-1279 CE (Imperial Chola / Chola Empire)

Features : powerful navy → conquered Sri Lanka and Maldives, Suzerainty with Indonesia  
Vijayalaya broke away from Pallava → built capital Thanjavur, temple Nishumbhasudini  
Rulers : Vijayalaya (850) → Aditya (870) → Parantaka (907) → Rajaraja I (985)  
Chola : Rajendra (1014) → Rajadhiraja (1044) → Kulothunga (1070) → Rajendra (1246)  
Admin : Mandala → Valanadus → Nadu → Villages (Taniyas)  
Royal roads, irrigation, Vellala (Rich caste), Muvendavelan (rich landowner)  
Economy : Taxes (Bhaga - land 1/3 produce, Uppagam - salt, Valigam - Goods, Hiranya - Land)  
Land grants → obsequious to Brahmin, Temple, Jain, school  
Polity : Ur → Non Brahmadeya village, assembly of male of upper 3 varnas  
Sabha → Brahmadeya village, assembly of brahmins only, No Kshatriya or women  
Nagaram → Port and trade cities, assembly of traders and merchant

## SMALL DYNASTIES

Hoysalas : 1026-1343 : Dwarasamudra (Karnataka) [ Built Temple : Chennakesava, Hoysaleswara  
Nripa Karna → Vishnuvardhana → Ballala II [ Jainism → Shaivism / Vaishnavism  
Yadavas : 850-1334 : Devagiri (Western Maharashtra) [ Rashtrakuta feudatories  
Dridhapratihara → Bhillama V → Singhana [ promoted Marathi and Sanskrit  
Kakatiyas : 1083-1323 : Warangal (Andhra Pradesh) [ Warangal fort, Kakatiya Kala Thoranam  
Beta → Granapati Deva → Rudramadevi [ Fell to Tughlaq invasion  
Senas : 1070-1230 : Nabadwip (Bengal) [ Replaced Palas, promoted Brahmanism  
Somanta Sena → Ballala → Lakshmana [ defeated by Bakhtiyar Khilji

# DELHI SULTANATE

## ADVENT OF TURKS 700 - 1190 CE

Turks: Tatbe in Central Asia, Islamic and Non Islamic (Christian and Jews)

800-900 CE: Abbasid Caliphate decline → Turks captured power → King makes (Samanid faction)

900-990 CE: Turks captured power → Ruled from Ghazni → Successor Mahmud of Ghazni

998-1030 CE: Fragmentation in India (No care) → Rajput / Chauhan / Solanki / Senas / Chandolas

Ghazni → Strike India 17 times, only to lost, Hindu shahi fought everytime → lost (alone, no help)

Attacked temples (richest institution) = devdana tax + donations

1030-1117 CE: Seljuks (Turks) → Khwarizmi dynasty + Ghurid Dynasty (Ghori)

RAJPUT DYNASTY: Tomar of Delhi → Anangpal captured Delhi → Prithviraj Chauhan → Tomar Feudatories  
Chauhans → Feudatories of Pratihars → Captured Ujjain Malwa → Shifted Delhi

BATTLE OF TERRAIN: 1175: Ghori passed through Gomal → Thar desert → weak → lost to Bhima Solanki  
1191: through Rhyber → 1st war of Terrain → lost to Prithvi Raj Chauhan  
1192: back with larger army → 2nd war of Terrain → won (No help to Prithvi Raj feudatory)

## DELHI SULTANATE 1206 - 1526 CE

Ghori created empire → moved back to Ghur → assassinated → divided reign Yalduz + Atbak

Mamluks: 1206-1290: Qutbuddin Aibak (1206) → Iltutmish (1211) → Razia (1236) → Balban (1266)  
Qutbuddin → Slave of Muizzuddin, ruled from Lahore, died playing Chaugan, Taziya  
Iltutmish → protect from Chengiz Khan, Iqta (admin task), Chahalgohari (40 nobility member)  
Balban → Restored power, Diwan-i-Arz (Army), Blood and Iron policy, Zillallah + Sijda

Khilji: 1290-1320: Jalaluddin Khilji (1290) → Allauddin (1296) → Qutbuddin → Nasiruddin  
Jalaluddin → Khilji revolution (Killed Chahalgohari Mamluks), check on Turkish monopoly  
Allauddin → Killed Jalaluddin, Ambitious and expansionary, fought mongols 4 times

Tughlaqs: 1320-1414: Tughlaq faction rise, Mother (Tat) + Father (Turg), reform + failed experiments  
Ghiyasuddin (1320) → Muhammad bin (1325) → Firozshah (1351) → Ghiyasuddin II → Abu Bakr  
Ghiyasuddin → created Tughlaqabad, conflict with Khwaja Nizamuddin, encouraged agriculture  
Muhammad bin → Failed reforms + 4 experiments → Decentralize empire  
Firoz Shah → created Diwan-i-Khairat, Diwan-i-Bundagan, Iqtadari, Taziya

Admin: Diwan (office of), Risalat boxun, Ariz military, Mamluk justice, Kahi agri, Khairat Chah,  
Land → Khazaj/Khalise → land tax via amin/amil, goes to Delhi, most fertile land, salary  
→ Iqta → Land grants, by Iltutmish, if excess collection → send to centre  
(Firoz Shah → Iqta hereditary), Big (Iqtadari/Mughawali), Small (Khut, Mugaddam)

Economy: Upward mobility, agrarian expansion using irrigation, urbanization  
Allauddin → control market → low cost of living, army cost low (for counter Mongol)  
controlling: Peasant (low cost produce) → Trades (no hoarding, low cost) → Seller (Mandi)

Muhammad Tughlaq exp: Moving capital South (Daulatabad) → Complex shift → again moved to Delhi  
Tonka (Token currency) → Bronze coin with silver value → Market broke down  
Khorasan expedition → Army (high salary) → to attack Rhyberpan → never happened  
Qarachil Expedition → Army against Chinese → died 50,000 due to cold

# VIJAYANAGAR - LODI

## VIJAYANAGAR EMPIRE : 1336-1646 CE

- Feature :** Strong hindu empire, resistance to islamic expansion, temple architecture  
Feudatories of Kakatiyas Empire → Creation of Vijayanagar in 1336 by Harihara / Bukka
- Rulers :** Sangama : Harihara → Bukka → Devaraya I, II (Tungabhadra region)  
Saluva : Narashima → Thomma Bhupala (Vasco da Gama land in this era)  
Tuluva : Naraya → Krishna Dev Raya → Sadasiva (Golden age, literator, largest empire)  
Achaladeva : Tisumala → Achyuta deva Raya (Weakest empire)
- Economy :** Agriculture + Taxation + Trade (Arab merchant, Horse trade, Luxury trade)  
market dealing with spices, textiles, precious stone, exotic goods.
- Admin :** Rajya (Province) → Nadu (District) → Shohda (Sub) → Grama (Village)  
Pradhana (ministers), Kanya Kartha (secretary), Gaudas (landlords), palau admin (Nigozis)
- Nayankara :** Amarnayaka system, Vijayanagar → Bhandaravada (Revenue) + Amara (Land grant)  
Nayak : Land given as service, in return he admin + revenue + Army + Law and order
- Agar :** Nayak work through Agar → decentralized villages, Reddi / Gauda gets lands (Mangra)
- Foreign :** Devaraya II : Nicolo De Conti (Italy), Abdul Razay (Persia)  
travellers : Krishna Dev Raya : Duarte Barbosa, Domingo Paes (Portugal)

## BAHAMANI DYNASTY 1347-1527 CE

- Feature :** Alauddin Bahmani declared independence from Tughlaqs, win over local chiefs  
First independent muslim Kingdom in deccan, rival of Vijayanagar
- Rulers :** Alauddin Hasan → Muhammad Shah II → Firuz Shah → Mohammad Gawan  
Firuz Shah : Remarkable steps for arts, poet, calligraphist, literature, astronomy  
Mohammad Gawan → Expanded Territory, internal reforms, art & culture
- Admin :** Weak in accounting → Employed Deccani Brahmin  
Wakil (PM), Wazir (Minister), Bakshi (paymaster), Qazi (Judge), Kotwal (police)
- Battle of Talikota :** 1565 → b/w Vijayanagar → Collapse of Vijayanagar empire.

## SAYYID DYNASTY 1414-1451 CE

- Feature :** Invasion of Timur (faction of Genghis Khan) → looted delhi → Khizr Khan as Governor  
Weak central control, frequent rebellion + regional autonomy
- Rulers :** Khizr Khan (1414) → Mubarak Shah → Muhammad Shah → Alauddin Alam Shah  
declined after attack of Bahlol Lodi

## LODI DYNASTY 1450-1526 CE

- Feature :** Improved agriculture, added afghan policy, last delhi sultanate (next Mughals)  
consolidated Punjab and Delhi, conflict with Rajput and Mevar
- Rulers :** Bahlol Lodhi (1451) → Sikandar Lodhi (1489) → Ibrahim Lodhi (1517)  
Daulat Khan Lodhi (Punjab gov) → invited Babur to annex Ibrahim Lodhi

# MUGHAL EMPIRE

## MUGHAL EMPIRE

1526-1857

ORIGIN : Timurid Empire broke into 3 : Ottomans + Safavids + Mughols (Babur in east area)

Babur → Ruler of Fargana (Afghanistan) → Running from Uzbeks → sitting in Kabul

Daulat Khan Lodi → Invited him to conquer Ibrahim Lodi and move back to Kabul

1526 : Battle of Panipat → Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi → Captured Delhi

1527 : Battle of Khonua → Babur defeated Rana Sanga → Captured North

1528 : Battle of Chanderi → Defeated Medini Rai → Captured alliance of Rajput

1529 : Battle of Ghaghra → Defeated Afghan chieftan and Sultan of Bengal

Babur used Tulughma / Rumi Technique → attack from all 4 sides → win

1529 : Established proper Kingdom → After rule → Mongol tradition → distributed empire into 4 sons  
Humayun (Delhi/Agra) + Kamran (Kabul) + Askari (Lahore) + Hindal (Agra)

## HUMAYUN

1530-1540, 1555-1556

Not united to fight external threats, Bad relation with siblings → weak empire

1539 : Battle of Chausa → lost to Sher Shah

1540 : Battle of Kanauj → lost to Sher Shah → founded Sur dynasty → for 15 years

1555 : fought Sikandar Shah Suri → Humayun recaptured Delhi → Ruled for 6 months

## SHER SHAH SURI

1540-1555

Restored law and order, Subdued Zamindars small rulers, Restored trade, Multiple reforms

Admin : Sarkar → Pargana → Village, General admin (shiqdar-i-shiqdaran / faujdar)

Revenue : Ray → differential rate of conversion of crop, based on prevailing market rate  
Danungo (Create market price list) → Finance Minister (Callatirates) → Amin (Collect tax)

Trade : Grand trunk road (Lahore to Bengal) + Law order + Sarais 8km (Hotel + market) +  
Multiple taxation point + tri metalism tax collection (Gold (Dinar) + Silver (Rupia) + Copper (Dami))

## AKBAR

1556-1605

Crowned at age of 14, at Kolonsun after his father Humayun death

Bairam Khan (Regent, fought Panipat, won → went to Mejj), Mahama Anja (Political Issue)

1556-1570 : fought Suris and Afghan, Malwa, Gondwana, Chittor, Ranthambhor

1570-1585 : Bihar, Bengal, Orissa

1585-1605 : Gondwan, Kashmir, Kabul. Last year of reign → against rebellion of prince Jahangir

## JAHANGIR

1605-1627

Conflict with sons Khurram (Imprisoned) and Khurram (Shah Jahan), Biography - Tuzukhi-Jahangir

Issued 12 ordinance, Zanjir il Adal (Chain of Justice) in Agra, Married to Noor Jahan (Badshah Begum)

Jahangir granted trade concession to William Hawkins, Sir Thomas Roe

## SHAH JAHAN

1627-1658

became part of Noor Jahan rebel → rebelled → surrendered → defeated sister husband → Crowned

Golden age of Mughal architecture → Taj Mahal, Red Fort

Continued campaign in Deccan (Ahmednagar, Bundelas, Orchna seized)

Shah Jahan imprisoned by son Aurangzeb till his death.

## AURANGZEB

1658-1707

Aurangzeb fought brother and Dara Shikoh for throne, titled himself Alamgir

1658 → Battle of Bahadurpur (Suleman) → Samugash (Aurangzeb) → Dharmatpur (Aurangzeb)

Orthodox Muslim → banned singing + Dancing, reintroduced Jizyah, Pilgrimage tax

Expanded to Deccan, longest reign, faced Maratha resistance

After conflict amongst his sons → died

## MUGHAL EMPIRE 1526 - 1857

Admin : Sultan → Wazir (Pri) → Suba (Subedar) → Sarkar (Faujdar) → Pargana (District) → Villages  
Finance → Diwani kul → Diwan → Amil / Amin  
Defence → Mir Bakshi → Bakshi → Faujdar  
Wazir / Diwan (Revenue), Bando (Intelligence), Wajia nawis (News), Qazi (Judicial)

Shershah Suri → Ray Price list, Problem → Qanungo wrong data, delay in list computation, heavy calculation  
Akbar reforms → Karori (Officers) cross check data, Dohsala (10 yrs avg) → less calculation, early list  
Zabti system (ray list + land measure), Barren land (Small tax)

Amin tax : Zabti (land size assessment), Khet Batai (Yield sold by Amil)  
Calculation : Ghalla Bakshi (Amil sells haystack), Lang Batai (Amil collect 1/2 of grain)  
Bhadi (Good + Bad Batai taken), Khankut (Random select), Nasag (last year revenue)

Agrarian : Cultivable lands : Polaj, Paratti, Chanchor, Banjar, Taccari  
classes : Land division : Khalisa (Emperor), Jagir (nobles / mansabdar), Inam (religious)  
Zamindar : Land owner, type - autonomous / intermediaries / zamindars  
Peasant : Khud Kasht (same village), Pahi Kasht (migratory)  
Agri Labour : Muzarain (Own equipment), Majur / Holi (Land owner provides)

Mansabdari : by Akbar → grading system used by Mughal to rank and pay their officials  
Zat : 5000 (panch hazari) → 4000 → 2000 → 1000 → 500  
Mansabdar paid in cash or jagir, Pahi Jagir → Jagirs are allocated in lieu of service  
Jagirdar system = Igta + Military obligation (Defined by sawar rank)

## RAJPUT POLICY

Babar, Humayun → No policy, Shu Shah → Suzerainty (Overlordship - Mehar, Jaipur)

Akbar → needed Rajput in the minister → saw loyalty in the Rajput

Fear (Power + attack) → Option of Watan Jagir (Suzerainty) → Fight and die

Worked → Matrimonial relation + Akbar nobility has 18% of Rajput

Jahangir, Shah Jahan → both used same Akbar policy, Aurangzeb → reversed policy.

## RELIGIOUS POLICY

Jizya : Muslim ruler collected Jizya from Hindus, Buddhist, Jain, Sikhs

Pilgrimage tax : tax imposed on pilgrims who travelled to religious / sacred places

Akbar policy : In influence of Hindu wife → removed Jizya and pilgrimage tax

Ibadat Khana → Understand Islam and other religions, debates  
loved by other religion, hated by muslim, Akbar got several fatwas

Sulh-i-Kul → Akbar interpretation of religion, mixture of all religion

Akbar : Imam Adel → Interpreter of Islam

Aurangzeb : reintroduced Jizya tax, removed music, dance as unislamic

Mushtakib : Morality of Islamic people in public

## DECLINE OF MUGHAL

Weak successor + Economic Bankruptcy + Invasion + Jaghirdar Crisis

+ Rebellion and Agrarian Distress + Religious policy.